



CO-PRIMAZOL SUSPENSION

Description: orange coloured, cherry flavoured suspension.

Each 5ml contains	Sulphamethoxazole	200mg
	Trimethoprim	40mg
	Methylparaben	0.1% w/v
	Propylparaben	0.01% w/v

Pharmacology

Co-trimoxazole a bactericide, inhibits sequential steps in the formation of tetrahydrofolic acid, sulphamethoxazole that of formation of dihydrofolic acid, and trimethoprim that of dihydrofolate to tetrahydrofolic acid. Oral absorption is rapid and elimination is by renal excretion.

Indications

It is used in the treatment of urinary tract infections, Pneumocystis Carinii pneumonia, intra-abdominal infections, genitourinary tract infections, burn wound infections, acute otitis media, and various pulmonary infections caused by Streptococcus pneumoniae and Haemophilus influenzae.

Adverse Effects

Nausea or vomiting, diarrhoea, headache, anorexia, abdominal pain, dizziness, muscle weakness, fatigue, hypersensitivity reactions, crystalluria, acidosis, hypothyroidism, insomnia, vertigo, tinnitus, confusion, depression, polyarteritis nodosa, peripheral neuritis and blood disorders may occur occasionally.

Vascular disorders

Frequency 'not known': circulatory shock

Precautions

- Caution in patients with glucose-6-phosphate dehydrogenase (G6PD) deficiency, porphyria, hepatic and renal function impairment.
- It should be used with caution in nursing mothers.
- Repeated haematological determinations are required during prolonged therapy.
- Adequate fluid intake should be maintained.
- There is an increased risk of adverse reactions in elderly patients, in particular blood disorders and adverse renal/hepatic reactions.
- **Respiratory toxicity:** Very rare, severe cases of respiratory toxicity, sometimes progressing to Acute Respiratory Distress Syndrome (ARDS), have been reported during co-trimoxazole treatment. The onset of pulmonary signs such as cough, fever and dyspnoea in association with radiological signs of pulmonary infiltrates, and deterioration in pulmonary function may be preliminary signs of ARDS. In such circumstances, co-trimoxazole should be discontinued and appropriate treatment given.
- **Circulatory shock:** Cases of circulatory shock, often accompanied by fever and not responding to standard treatment for hypersensitivity, have been reported with sulfamethoxazole + trimethoprim, mainly in immunocompromised patients.

Contraindications

- Avoid in patients hypersensitive to either sulphonamides or trimethoprim
- It should not be given to patients with megaloblastic anaemia or during pregnancy.

Drug Interactions

- Co-trimoxazole increases the effects of the coumarin anticoagulants, sulfonylurea oral hypoglycemics, phenytoin, and methotrexate.
- Close observation for toxic effects is required in patients receiving immunosuppressive therapy.

Overdosage

Clinical signs include Stevens-Johnson and Lyell's syndromes, blood dyscrasias, methemoglobinemia, crystalluria, hematuria, and gastrointestinal disturbances.

Treatment consists of the necessary symptomatic and supportive therapy.

Bone marrow depression due to trimethoprim may be treated with calcium folinate 3 to 6 mg intramuscularly daily for 5 to 7 days.

Dosage and Administration

- Adults : Oral, 4 teaspoonfuls (20ml) 12 hours for up to 14 days.
- Children 1½ to 5 months : Oral, 1/2 teaspoonful (2.5ml) every 12 hours.
- 6 months to 5 years : Oral, 1 teaspoonful (5ml) every 12 hours.
- 6 to 12 years : Oral, 2 teaspoonful (10ml) every 12 hours.

For *Pneumocystis Carinii* pneumonia:

Adults and children over 1 month:

Oral, 25mg of sulphamethoxazole and 5mg of trimethoprim per kg of body weight every 6 hours for 14 days.

Note: The prescribed course should be completed.

The medication should preferably be taken on an empty stomach.

Fatalities associated with the administration of sulphonamides and trimethoprim, either alone or in combination, have occurred due to severe reactions, including Stevens-Johnson syndrome, toxic epidermal necrolysis and other reactions. The drug should be discontinued at the first appearance of skin rash or any sign of adverse reaction.

Storage	: Keep container tightly closed. Store in a cool, dry place below 30°C. Protect from light. Keep away from children.
Shelflife	: 2 years
Presentation/Packing	: Suspension x60ml
Product registration holder	: PRIME PHARMACEUTICAL SDN.BHD.
& Manufacturer	: 1505, Lorong Perusahaan Utama 1, Taman Perindustrian Bukit Tengah, 14000 Bukit Mertajam, Penang, Malaysia.

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